



ACTIVE LISTENING AND NOTE-TAKING

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LEARNING OBJECTIVES

At the end of the lesson, you should be able to

- Enhance your ability to actively listen in various contexts, leading to better comprehension and retention of information presented in lectures, discussions, and conversations.
- Apply listening skills and organise notes systematically and review them.
- Adapt note-taking strategies to various contexts, like: academic lectures, business meetings, or social interactions.





ACTIVE LISTENING

Logical and critical reasoning are essential skills for creating meaningful presentations that effectively communicate your message and persuade your audience. Here are some tips on how to incorporate these skills into your presentation:





IMPORTANCE OF ACTIVE LISTENING

Active listening is a fundamental component of effective communication and plays a crucial role in both personal and professional interactions.





ACTIVE LISTENING - ENHANCED UNDERSTANDING

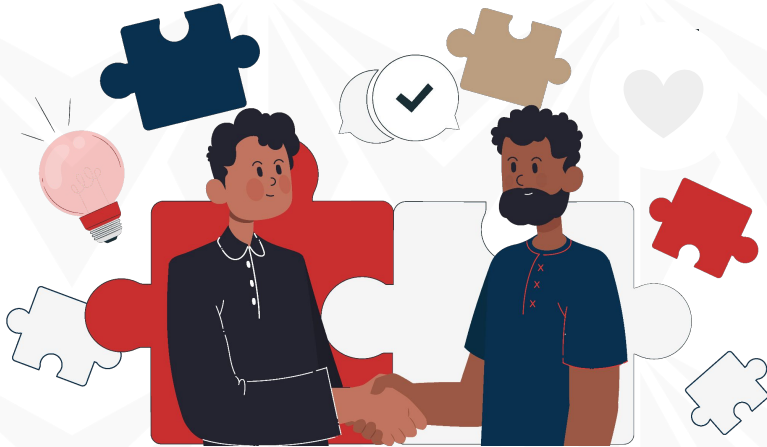
Active listening helps the listener better understand the speaker's message. By actively engaging with the speaker, the listener can grasp not only the words spoken but also the underlying emotions, intentions, and context. This understanding is essential for meaningful and productive communication.





ACTIVE LISTENING - CONFLICT RESOLUTION

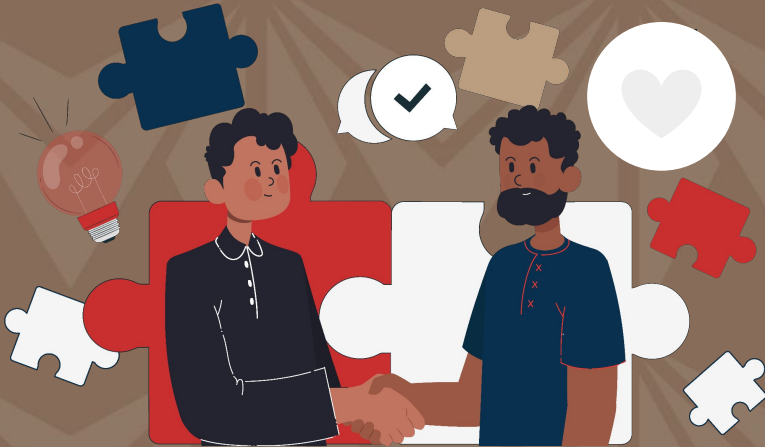
Active listening is a key skill in conflict resolution. It allows individuals to acknowledge each other's perspectives, which is a crucial step in finding common ground and resolving disputes.





ACTIVE LISTENING - PROBLEM SOLVING

Actively listening can lead to more effective problem-solving. By fully comprehending the details of a problem or issue, the listener is better equipped to provide informed solutions or suggestions.





TECHNIQUES FOR BECOMING A MORE ACTIVE LISTENER

Maintain Eye Contact: Making eye contact with the speaker conveys your attention and interest. It's a non-verbal cue that signals your active engagement in the conversation.

Avoid Interrupting: Resist the urge to interrupt the speaker. Let them finish their thoughts before responding. Interruptions can hinder the flow of communication and make the speaker feel unheard.





TECHNIQUES FOR BECOMING A MORE ACTIVE LISTENER

Minimise distractions

Ask open-ended questions





TECHNIQUES FOR BECOMING A MORE ACTIVE LISTENER

Use Verbal and Non-Verbal Affirmations

Nodding, smiling, or providing verbal cues like "I see," "I understand," or "Tell me more" can encourage the speaker to continue sharing and express that you're actively listening.

Paraphrase and Summarise

Periodically paraphrasing or summarizing what the speaker has said demonstrates that you're not only listening but also trying to comprehend their message accurately. It provides an opportunity for clarification.





TECHNIQUES FOR BECOMING A MORE ACTIVE LISTENER

What techniques or strategies can you employ to enhance your active listening skills?



EFFECTIVE NOTE-TAKING IN LISTENING





NOTE-TAKING

Note-taking is a critical skill for students and professionals alike, particularly when listening to lectures, presentations, or spoken content. Effective note-taking techniques can enhance one's ability to understand, retain, and later recall important information.

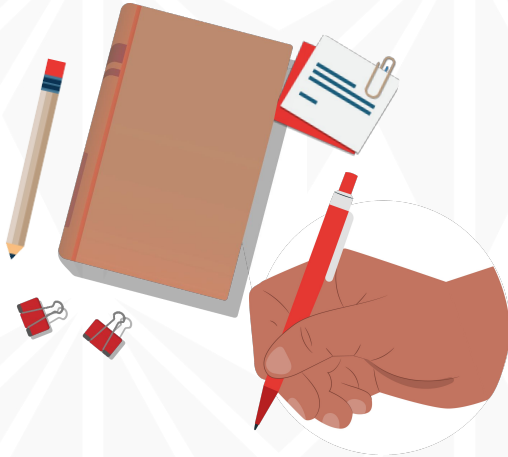




TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Ensure you have writing materials with you.

- Pen/ pencil
- Book / jotter / sticky notes
- Highlighters
- Paper clips, etc.





TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Use Abbreviations and Symbols:

Develop a system of abbreviations and symbols that allow you to write faster without sacrificing clarity.

For example, "w/" for "with" or "→" for "leads to."

Remember, this is a personal note, not to be turned in or submitted. Abbreviations and symbols may not be tolerated in formal writings.





TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Listen attentively and do not write what you hear verbatim. Just jot down important notes in clear and simple sentences. Focus on capturing main ideas, key concepts, and supporting evidence, rather than transcribing everything. This prevents information overload and ensures that your notes are more concise.





TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Headings and Subheadings

Organise your notes using headings and subheadings to create a clear structure. This helps in finding specific information later.

Highlighting or Underlining

Use different colors or underlines to emphasise key points or important terms. This visual cue can make it easier to review and study your notes.





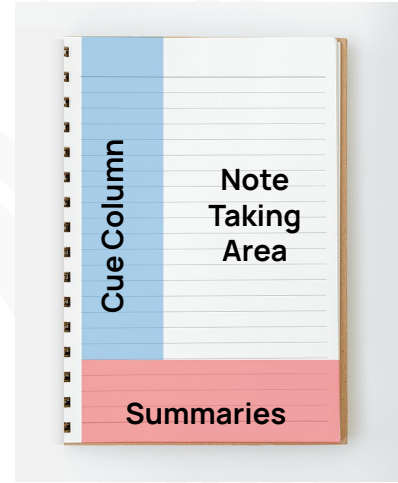
TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Cornell Note-Taking Method:

The Cornell method involves dividing your paper into sections for notes, cues, and a summary.

It encourages you to summarise the main ideas shortly after the lecture.

Also use bullet points. Organise information using bullet points to make it more scannable and easier to review.

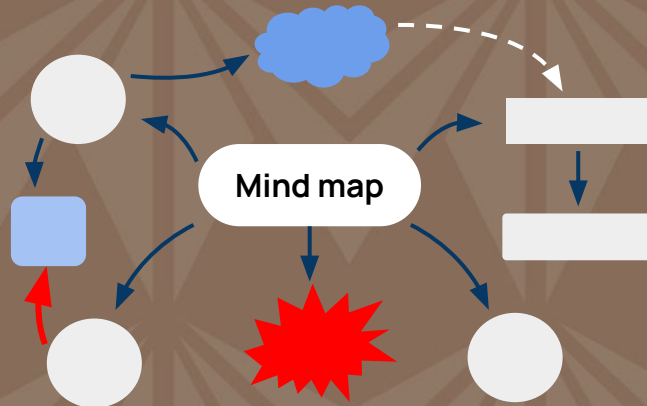




TIPS ON NOTE-TAKING

Mind Mapping

Create visual representations of the content, connecting main ideas to subtopics and supporting details using a mind map format.





NOTE-TAKING

What note-taking strategies have you found most effective for retaining and understanding course material, and how do you adapt your approach for different types of lectures or subjects?





SUMMARY

In summary, the combination of active listening and note-taking skills leads to more efficient information processing, better understanding, and improved retention, benefiting both personal and professional contexts. The combined skills aid in collecting, organising, and analyzing information, which can lead to better informed decision-making.





FURTHER READING & REFERENCES

Emilia Hardman, (2012). Active Listening 101: How to Turn Down Your Volume to Turn Up Your Communication Skills.

The Open University, (2016). Reading and note taking – preparation for study.





THANK
YOU